

The leaflet

Inform and persuade at a glance

Word count	Register	Title	Key feature
~250 words	Persuasive, reader-friendly	Required - plus subheadings	Headed sections + call to action

STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Main title — names the offer or event clearly – and makes people want to read on
Short intro / hook — ~30–40 words – say what this is and why it matters to the reader
Subheading + section 1 — one benefit or block of information under its own heading
Subheading + section 2 — the next point – short, scannable, one idea per section
Subheading + section 3 (optional) — a further point if the word count allows
Call to action — tell the reader the one thing to do next (come, sign up, get in touch)
Practical details — date, time, place, price, website, phone – the facts people need

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Give it a clear title and break the text into short, headed sections
- Know exactly who the leaflet is for and write straight to them
- Sell the benefits, not just the facts – why should the reader care?
- Keep sections short and scannable – a leaflet is read standing up, not studied
- Address the reader directly ("you") and use imperatives: come along, find out more
- End with a clear call to action – the one thing you want the reader to do
- Add the practical details: date, time, place, price, how to get in touch
- Match the register to the audience, but keep it accessible – not slang, not bureaucratic

DON'T

- Don't write it as one long, unbroken block of text – a leaflet is broken into short, headed sections
- Don't drop the subheadings – they are what make it a leaflet at a glance
- Don't tell a personal story from your own life – a leaflet informs, it does not confess (that is a blog)
- Don't weigh arguments for and against – a leaflet promotes one thing, it does not debate it
- Don't slip into slang or txt-speak – persuasive is fine, sloppy is not
- Don't forget the call to action and the contact details – a leaflet with no next step is just decoration

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

This leaflet provides information about the annual town festival taking place in the market square.

STRONGER

Live music, free food and the whole town in one square: the Seetal Festival is back, and you are invited.

Why it matters. A leaflet has to grab a reader holding it for two seconds at a bus stop. The weak version describes itself like a report and gives no reason to care. The strong version leads with the benefits and speaks straight to the reader, which is exactly what a persuasive leaflet does.

KEY TIP

Key tip. A leaflet (the German curriculum documents call it a „Broschüre“) is not one long block of prose. It informs AND persuades a target audience, and the layout does half the work: a clear title, short headed sections, direct address and a call to action. Picture the reader holding it at a bus stop – everything has to land in seconds. Keep the register persuasive but clean: warmer than a report, cleaner than a blog. You write the text only – a title, headed sections and a call to action, never drawings or layout.

USEFUL PHRASES

Attention-grabbing openers

- Looking for something to do this summer?
- Ever wondered what goes on behind our doors?
- New to the area? Here is where to start.
- Something new is coming to your town – and everyone is welcome.
- Good news for anyone who loves...

Describing & persuading

- Whether you are a complete beginner or already experienced,...
- There really is something for everyone.
- It is easier – and cheaper – than you might think.
- Best of all, it is completely free.
- No experience needed – just come as you are.

Direct address & calls to action

- Come along and see for yourself.
- Sign up today – places are limited.
- Bring a friend and make a day of it.
- Find out more on our website.
- Do not miss out.

Practical information & closings

- When: Saturday, 14 June, from 10 a.m.
- Where: the main hall, Hauptstraße 1.
- Entry is free. / Tickets: €5.
- For more information, visit www....
- Questions? Call us on... or drop by any weekday.

MODEL TEXT

Open Day at Schulzentrum Seetal - See Your Future in Action (~250 words · Persuasive · actual count 260)

Open Day at Schulzentrum Seetal – See Your Future in Action

Not sure what to do after lower secondary school? Spend a morning with us and find out. On Saturday, 7 November, our whole school opens its doors: workshops, real projects and students who are happy to show you around. Come and see what studying here is actually like, with no pressure and no entrance test.

Try Before You Choose

Instead of reading about our courses, you can try them. In our workshops you can build a small circuit, plan a three-course menu or design a marketing campaign, all in a single morning. Teachers and senior students work alongside you, so there is no way to get it wrong.

Meet the People, Not Just the Building

Want to know what life here is really like? Ask the people who live it. Current students will show you the labs and workshops and answer your questions about lessons, homework and life after graduation.

Something for Every Interest

Whether you are drawn to technology, business or hospitality, there is a taster session waiting for you. Try your hand at coding, run a mini pop-up shop, or cook a small dish in our training kitchen. You will leave knowing which path actually suits you, not just which one sounds good in a brochure.

Come and See for Yourself

Bring your parents, bring a friend, bring your questions. Entry is free and no registration is needed.

When: Saturday, 7 November, 9 a.m. to 1 p.m.

Where: Schulzentrum Seetal, Bildungsweg 1, 1234 Seetal

More information: www.schulzentrum-seetal.example

WHAT THE EXAMINER NOTICES IN THIS MODEL

The marked features, in reading order:

Main title - names the event and sells it — “Open Day at Schulzentrum Seetal – See Your Future in Action”

Question aimed straight at the reader — “Not sure what to do after lower secondary school?”

Sells the benefit, not just the facts — “workshops, real projects and students who are happy to show you around”

Subheading - breaks the text into scannable sections — “Try Before You Choose”

Concrete, appealing detail — “build a small circuit, plan a three-course menu or design a marketing campaign”

Second subheading - parallel and benefit-led — “Meet the People, Not Just the Building”

Direct address keeps the reader involved — “Ask the people who live it.”

Speaks to HTL, HAK and HLW readers alike — “Whether you are drawn to technology, business or hospitality”

Concrete, varied activities keep it persuasive — “Try your hand at coding, run a mini pop-up shop, or cook a small dish”

Call to action - tells the reader exactly what to do — “Come and See for Yourself”

Imperatives + repetition - persuasive leaflet style — “Bring your parents, bring a friend, bring your questions.”

Practical details - the facts people need — “When: Saturday, 7 November, 9 a.m. to 1 p.m.”

Where: Schulzentrum Seetal, Bildungsweg 1, 1234 Seetal

More infor...”

More online. This text type also has a second model text on the website (“Recycle Right – The New Kerbside Scheme for Seetal”, ~250 words · persuasive) and an annotated “honest model” that shows a realistic borderline text. matura.bernhardgmeiner.com